

**Power of Interest**  
**Risk Management Policy**

**Version: 0.2**

**Approval date: 29th of July, 2026**

**Review date: July 2028**

## **1. Purpose and Scope**

The purpose of this policy is to establish a structured approach to identifying, assessing, and managing risks across all **Power of Interest (POI) UK** operations. By proactively managing risk, POI UK ensures the safety of its youth participants, protects its financial assets, and preserves its reputation as a trusted educational provider.

This policy applies to all Trustees, Directors, staff, university student coaches, adjudicators, and general volunteers.

## **2. Risk Management Principles**

- **Proactive Culture:** Risk management is an ongoing process integrated into tournament planning, workshop design, and daily governance, not a one-off box-ticking exercise.
- **Proportionality:** Actions taken to mitigate risks must be realistic, cost-effective, and aligned with the scale of our student-led budget.
- **The Risk Register:** The Board of Trustees will maintain a master **Risk Register** detailing identified risks, their potential impact, and the safety measures put in place to control them.

## **3. Key Risk Categories for POI UK**

### **A. Safeguarding & Welfare Risks**

- Strict integration with the **POI UK Safeguarding Policy**.

### **B. Operational & Event Risks (Tournaments & Workshops)**

- *Definition:* Incidents disrupting live events, such as venue cancellations, medical emergencies, or severe technical failure during online webinars.
- *Core Controls:*

- A designated, venue-approved **Risk Assessment Form** must be completed for every in-person tournament at least **14 days prior** to the event.
- On-site first aid access and clear fire evacuation briefings provided to all attending schools at the start of tournament days.
- Robust technical backups (alternative streaming links, co-hosts with presentation files) prepared for all online workshops.

### C. Financial Risks

- *Definition:* Loss of charity funds due to low tournament attendance, fraud, unexpected venue fees, or poor financial tracking.
- *Core Controls:*
  - Adherence to the **POI UK Financial Controls Policy** (dual authorization for bank transfers over £100).
  - Maintaining a minimum financial reserve equivalent to **6 months** of core operating costs to shield against sudden loss of funding.

### D. Equity & Reputational Risks

- *Definition:* Public backlash or loss of trust stemming from biased tournament adjudication, offensive/unvetted debate motions, or volunteer misconduct on social media.
- *Core Controls:*
  - All debate motions must be vetted by a *Motions Committee* or *Chief Adjudicator Panel* prior to a tournament to ensure they remain
  - An active **Tournament Equity Officer** must be present at every competition to handle interpersonal disputes instantly, aligned with the **POI UK Code of Conduct**.

## 4. Risk Assessment Framework (The 5x5 Matrix)

When logging risks in the master register, POI UK rates them based on **Likelihood** (1-5, rare to almost certain) and **Impact** (1-5, negligible to catastrophic).

$$[\text{Likelihood (1-5)}] \times [\text{Impact (1-5)}] = [\text{Risk Score (1-25)}]$$

- **Scores 1–6 (Low):** Acceptable risk; monitor via standard operating procedures.
- **Scores 8–12 (Medium):** Action required; put specific mitigation steps and backups in place.
- **Scores 15–25 (High):** Unacceptable; immediate intervention needed. Events or activities must not proceed until the score is reduced.

## 5. Roles and Responsibilities

- **The Trustees / Board of Directors:** Hold ultimate responsibility for reviewing and signing off on the master Risk Register every year.
- **Tournament Convenors / Session Leads:** Responsible for implementing the specific risk controls on-site (e.g., ensuring fire exits are clear, checking volunteer attendance lists).
- **Volunteers and Coaches:** Obligated to report any newly identified hazards, unsafe environments, or equity concerns immediately to a Director.